

Document 12: Internship Policy & NOC Guidelines

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. Foundational Internship Architecture

Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT) integrates corporate internships directly into its academic curriculum, recognizing that theoretical engineering knowledge must be tempered with real-world industrial exposure. The university formally categorizes internships into two distinct tracks: Short-Term Summer Internships (undertaken during the vacation months of June and July) and the Long-Term Semester Internship (undertaken exclusively during the eighth and final semester of the B.Tech program).

An internship is not considered a vacation or a break from academic obligations. Students undertaking an internship remain under the full legal and disciplinary jurisdiction of the university. Any professional misconduct, intellectual property theft, or breach of corporate non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) reported by the host company to the university will result in immediate academic suspension and potential cancellation of the student's degree.

The Training and Placement (T&P) Cell handles the procurement of on-campus internship opportunities, while the Departmental Internship Committee (DIC) governs the academic monitoring, credit mapping, and final evaluation of the intern's corporate performance.

2. The No-Objection Certificate (NOC) Protocol

A student is strictly prohibited from joining any corporate entity, research laboratory, or startup for an internship without first securing an official No-Objection Certificate (NOC) from the university. Joining a company without a digitally signed NOC renders the internship academically void, and zero credits will be awarded regardless of the student's performance.

The NOC is a legally binding university document stating that the institution has vetted the host company, verified the student's academic eligibility, and officially permitted the student to temporarily relocate for corporate duty.

The NOC Application Workflow:

1. **Offer Verification:** The student must upload their official corporate offer letter (on company letterhead, clearly stating the start date, end date, role, and stipend) to the DIC portal.
2. **Faculty Advisor Endorsement:** The student's Faculty Advisor must digitally sign the application, confirming the student does not have any critical attendance shortages or pending disciplinary actions.
3. **Clearance of Dues:** The accounts department automatically checks the student's ledger. An NOC will be instantly rejected if the student has pending tuition fees, unpaid hostel rent, or outstanding library fines.
4. **Final Issuance:** If all criteria are met, the Head of the Department issues the digitally watermarked NOC within exactly seven working days of the application submission.

Students must apply for the NOC at least fourteen calendar days before their official corporate joining date. Emergency, backdated, or overnight NOC requests will not be entertained under any administrative circumstances.

3. Short-Term Summer Internship Regulations (2nd and 3rd Year)

To build their corporate resumes, students in their second and third years of study are highly encouraged to pursue Short-Term Summer Internships. These internships must be scheduled strictly during the six-week university summer vacation window (typically spanning mid-June to late July).

- **Duration Restrictions:** A summer internship must have a minimum continuous duration of four weeks and a maximum duration of six weeks. It cannot, under any circumstances, overlap with the commencement of the odd semester classes in August. If a company demands that a student stay into August, the student must resign from the internship; otherwise, they will face daily attendance penalties for missing standard classes.
- **Academic Credit Weightage:** Summer internships do not replace any core semester subjects. However, a successfully completed summer internship evaluated by the DIC will be awarded two bonus academic credits. These credits are added to the student's overall portfolio and printed on the final transcript under the "Extracurricular & Industrial Exposure" category.
- **Stipend and Fees:** The university does not enforce a minimum stipend rule for short-term summer internships. Students are permitted to take unpaid internships during this period. However, students paying for "training internships" (where the company charges the student a fee to teach them skills) will not be awarded any academic credits, as the university classifies these as paid tutorials rather than legitimate industrial work.

4. Semester-Long Industry Internship Rules (8th Semester)

The Long-Term Semester Internship is the pinnacle of the HIT experiential learning model. Eligible students are permitted to leave the campus entirely during their eighth semester to work full-time at a registered corporation for a continuous period of four to six months (January to June).

This massive industrial undertaking completely replaces the traditional "Major Final Year Project" and all eighth-semester elective coursework. It carries a massive weight of exactly sixteen academic credits.

Strict Eligibility Gatekeeping for the 8th Semester Internship: Because the student will be representing the university in a full-time corporate capacity for half a year, the academic filtering is ruthless. To be granted an NOC for a semester-long internship, a student must satisfy all three of the following conditions at the end of their seventh semester:

1. **The CGPA Floor:** The student must maintain a Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) strictly greater than or equal to 7.0.
2. **Absolute Zero Backlogs:** The student must have cleared every single subject, laboratory, and minor project from semester one through semester seven. A student with even one active backlog is legally bound to remain on campus to clear their deficit and must execute an internal academic project instead of a corporate internship.
3. **The Minimum Stipend Mandate:** Unlike summer internships, a semester-long internship must be a paid position. The host company must offer a minimum guaranteed stipend of ₹15,000 per month. Startup equity, promised future bonuses, or "unpaid experience" offers will be summarily rejected by the DIC. The university enforces this rule to prevent the exploitation of its senior engineering students as free corporate labor.

5. Academic Tracking and The Weekly Corporate Diary

When a student leaves campus for a six-month internship, they do not escape academic oversight. The DIC assigns every intern an Internal Faculty Guide who is responsible for tracking the student's corporate progression. Simultaneously, the host company must designate an External Corporate Manager to supervise the student's daily work.

The core tracking mechanism is the **Digital Internship Diary**.

- Every Friday before 5:00 PM, the intern must draft a detailed weekly report summarizing the specific technical tasks completed, software tools utilized, and corporate meetings attended.
- This report must be digitally signed or officially emailed by the External Corporate Manager to verify its authenticity.
- The verified report must be uploaded to the DIC portal by Sunday midnight.
- **The Strike System:** If a student fails to upload their verified weekly report for two consecutive weeks, they receive a formal warning. If they miss a third week, the DIC considers the student to be absconding. The university will unilaterally revoke the student's NOC, legally forcing the company to terminate the internship, and the student will be summoned back to campus to face a disciplinary hearing.

6. Final Evaluation, Viva Voce, and Credit Awarding

The sixteen credits associated with the semester-long internship are not awarded simply for attending the corporate office. The student must pass a rigorous academic defense of their corporate work at the end of the semester.

In the second week of June, all interns must return to the HIT campus for the Final Evaluation Phase. The evaluation is marked out of a total of two hundred marks, split evenly into two components:

1. **The Corporate Manager's Evaluation (100 Marks):** The host company's manager fills out a confidential, sealed evaluation rubric scoring the intern on technical competency, punctuality, teamwork, and professional communication.
2. **The Institutional Viva Voce (100 Marks):** The student must submit a massive, formally bound "Internship Thesis Report" detailing their six months of work (scrubbed of corporate confidential data). They must then present a technical PowerPoint defense before a panel consisting of the Head of the Department, the Internal Faculty Guide, and one External Academic Examiner invited from a different university.

To pass the eighth semester, the student must secure a minimum of fifty marks from the Corporate Manager and a minimum of fifty marks from the Institutional Viva Voce. Failing either component results in an automatic F-grade for the entire sixteen-credit internship.

7. Absconding, Corporate Termination, and Academic Penalties

The university treats corporate professionalism with extreme gravity. If an internship ends prematurely, the academic consequences are devastating.

- **Voluntary Absconding:** If a student voluntarily quits their internship midway through the semester because they find the work "too difficult" or they "do not like the company culture" without securing prior written permission from the Chief Placement Officer, they will be instantly awarded an F-grade for the eighth semester. They will suffer a mandatory Year-Back and must repeat the entire final semester the following year.
- **Corporate Termination (Firing):** If the host company officially fires the intern for severe misconduct, intellectual property theft, chronic absenteeism, or gross technical incompetence, the company will send a termination dossier to the university. The student will be permanently barred from the campus placement portal, awarded an F-grade for the semester, and summoned before the Disciplinary Action Committee (DAC). Depending on the severity of the corporate offense, the DAC holds the right to permanently rusticate the student, completely revoking their four years of engineering study.
- **Medical Exits:** If a student must abandon their internship due to a severe, documented medical emergency (such as a severe accident requiring months of bed rest), the university will freeze their semester progression without penalty. The student will be granted a medical leave of absence and allowed to resume their eighth-semester requirements in the next academic cycle without paying additional tuition fees.